
Project guide

Python-only reproduction package for the MAS LCE fraudulent-classified-ads study

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What this package is

This package is a self-contained English compendium built from the archived David Graz MAS LCE project. It contains:

- an article-style reconstruction of the thesis;
- a dedicated integrity and reproducibility audit;
- sanitised canonical datasets that are sufficient to reproduce the published descriptive tables and the archived predictive metrics;
- Python scripts that regenerate tables, figures, manifests, checksums, and PDF reports;
- metadata files that document provenance, version drift, and canonicalisation choices.

1 Package structure

Path	Contents
reports/	Final PDFs and LaTeX sources for the article, audit, and guide
figures/	Reproduced figures used by the reports
data/canonical/	Sanitised canonical exploratory and case-study datasets
data/tables/	CSV tables used in the reports
data/json/	JSON summaries used to populate the LaTeX reports
data/metadata/	Source inventory, discrepancy logs, checksums, manifest, and data dictionary
scripts/	Python-only build and analysis scripts

2 How to rebuild the package

The package is designed so that the main build command is a Python script.

```
python scripts/build_all.py --use-packaged-data
```

If you also have access to the original extracted `_Master_LCE_Docs` directory, you can regenerate the canonical datasets and the inventory directly from the source corpus:

```
python scripts/build_all.py --source-root /path/to/_Master_LCE_Docs
```

The build script regenerates:

- canonical CSV datasets;
- descriptive and discrepancy tables;
- ROC and indicator-distribution figures;
- LaTeX files and compiled PDFs;
- a manifest and SHA-256 checksums for all package files.

3 Canonical datasets

Two canonical datasets are bundled because the archive contains multiple versions of the same analyses.

- `exploratory_sample_canonical.csv` reproduces the exploratory verification sample used by the thesis and by the archived exploratory random-forest script.
- `case_study_sample_canonical.csv` reproduces the broader case-study sample whose counts and predictive metrics match the final thesis narrative.

Both canonical files are sanitised: personally identifying profile fields, links, message fragments, and contact artefacts were removed because they are not necessary for the quantitative reproduction.

4 Data dictionary

Field	Meaning
<code>listing_id</code>	Stable listing identifier inside the archived dataset
<code>source_status</code>	Archived manual status (POSITIVE, NEGATIVE, IDENTIFIED, DETECTED)
<code>ad_text</code>	Listing description text
<code>price_chf</code>	Listing price in CHF-equivalent numeric form
<code>profile_creation_year</code>	Year the seller profile was created; missing for opaque profiles
<code>content_score</code> / <code>price_score</code> / <code>profile_score</code>	Encoded operational indicators used by the original project
<code>fraud_index</code>	Sum of indicator scores used by the thesis
<code>risk_target</code>	Binary operational target: 0 = acceptable, 1 = unfavorable
<code>price_ratio</code>	Derived ratio between listing price and the model-specific market benchmark

5 Integrity and ethics notes

The source archive contains 1024 files, including legacy materials that should not be reused operationally. In particular:

- legacy scraper scripts with embedded credentials were excluded from the compendium;
- early similarity scripts with self-comparison bugs were excluded from the final analysis pipeline;
- reproduction is intentionally offline and depends on archived snapshots rather than fresh scraping.

6 Reading order

For most users, the recommended order is:

1. read the article-style reconstruction;
2. read the integrity audit to understand what was reproduced and what remains uncertain;
3. inspect the canonical datasets and the metadata tables if you need technical traceability;
4. run `python scripts/build_all.py -use-packaged-data` if you want to regenerate all outputs.

7 Complete bibliography inherited from the original thesis

The original thesis contains a bibliography than could reasonably be cited in the body of every articles. The complete bibliography inherited from the thesis is reproduced below. It preserves the original documentary basis while every article uses a tighter, argument-driven set of cited references.

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